



▲ IRON MACE

Date 14th century
Origin China or Mongolia
Weight 1.17kg (2½lb)
Length 40cm (15¾in)

This iron mace dates from the period when the Mongols, under Kublai Khan, overthrew the native ruling dynasty of China and took power. The intricate decoration suggests that it belonged to a warrior of high status.



▲ BOW CASE

Date 15th century
Origin Mongolia
Material Leather

Mongol warriors protected their precious composite bows by carrying them in leather cases, which were slung on their left side while riding. They were designed to give the warrior easy access to his bow while on horseback.



▲ MONGOL DAGGERS

Date 14th century
Origin Mongolia

Various types of short swords and daggers were used by Mongol warriors for close-quarter combat. These are modern replicas in the style of the 14th century.

Silver blade with deep fuller

Ivory-inlaid handle

Quiver carried about 60 arrows



Silver inlaid crest

◀ BOW IN MONGOL STYLE

Date 18th century
Origin China
Weight 1.07kg (2½lb)
Length 79.4cm (31¼in)

The composite bows used by the Mongols were made up of laminated layers of wood, horn, and sinew, which gave them greater elasticity and thus a longer range than a simple wooden bow. These bows had maximum strength for minimum length, a valuable attribute on horseback.

Tip recurves away from archer

Animal hide string

▲ QUIVER

Date 15th century
Origin Mongolia
Material Leather

A Mongol quiver was divided into a number of sections, allowing the warrior to quickly select different arrows for different purposes – heavy ones for piercing armour, or light ones for long-range firing. Arrows with scissor-shaped heads were designed to make deep flesh wounds in the bow arms of their enemies.



Steel neck protector

▲ NOGAI HELMET

Date Late 16th century
Origin Russia
Material Steel, iron, silver

This late Mongol helmet of the Nogai people (descendants of Genghis Khan) retains the conical shape of earlier types, but the neck guard is made of mail rather than leather.